

Canning timeline puzzle — Answer keys

Correct order for each process (the same order is used for both Kids and Teen/Adult decks).

MAKING STRAWBERRY JAM

1. Sterilize canning jars. Crush 2 quarts of strawberries as preparation for jam.
2. Combine crushed strawberries with 6 cups sugar; stir occasionally to dissolve sugar before cooking.
3. Bring mixture slowly to boiling over medium heat, stirring occasionally to dissolve sugar.
4. Cook rapidly until thick, about 40 minutes, stirring frequently to prevent sticking or burning.
5. Use temperature test: Jam is ready when it reaches 220 deg F (104 deg C) at sea level or gels when cooled on a plate.
6. Skim off foam carefully from the surface before filling jars.
7. [SAFETY] Ladle hot jam into hot sterilized jars, leaving 1/4 inch headspace; remove air bubbles; clean jar rims.
8. [SAFETY] Wipe jar rims thoroughly to remove any jam residue to ensure proper sealing.
9. [SAFETY] Apply sterilized lids and screw bands on jars fingertip tight to allow air to escape during processing.
10. [SAFETY] Place jars on rack in boiling water canner; add water to cover jars by at least 1 inch.
11. [SAFETY] Process half-pint or pint jars 5 minutes at 0-1000 ft altitude; increase processing time with altitude adjustments.
12. [SAFETY] At end of processing, turn off heat, remove canner lid, wait 5 minutes before removing jars to prevent liquid loss or seal failure.
13. [SAFETY] Place jars on towel or rack, do not disturb for 12-24 hours to allow proper sealing.
14. [SAFETY] Test seals after cooling: lids should be concave and not move when pressed.
15. Remove rings, clean jars, label with contents and date, and store in cool, dry, dark location for best quality.

CANNING WHOLE TOMATOES

1. Select firm, ripe tomatoes. Wash and trim off bruised or discolored portions.
2. Dip tomatoes in boiling water for 30 to 60 seconds or until skins split.
3. Dip in cold water to cool, slip off skins, and remove cores.
4. [SAFETY] Add 2 Tablespoons bottled lemon juice or 1/2 teaspoon citric acid per quart jar (half amounts for pints) directly into each jar before filling.
5. [SAFETY] Pack tomatoes raw or hot. For raw pack: fill jars with raw tomatoes and cover with hot tomato juice or water, leaving 1/2 inch headspace. For hot pack: boil tomatoes gently 5 minutes, then fill jars with hot tomatoes and hot liquid, leaving 1/2 inch headspace.
6. If desired, add 1/2 teaspoon salt per pint or 1 teaspoon per quart for flavor, but not for safety.
7. [SAFETY] Remove air bubbles by running a non-metallic spatula or bubble remover around inside jar before sealing.
8. [SAFETY] Wipe jar rims with a clean damp cloth or paper towel to ensure a clean sealing surface.
9. [SAFETY] Place flat metal lid on jar, then screw on the self-sealing metal band fingertip tight.
10. [SAFETY] Process jars in a boiling water canner with 1-2 inches of boiling water covering the tops of jars.
11. [SAFETY] Process pint jars for 40 minutes in boiling water canner at altitudes 0-1,000 feet; adjust time for altitude as needed.
12. [SAFETY] Process quart jars for 45 minutes in boiling water canner at altitudes 0-1,000 feet; increase processing time for higher elevations.
13. [SAFETY] After processing time, turn off heat, remove canner lid carefully, and wait 5 minutes before removing jars.
14. [SAFETY] Cool jars undisturbed on towels or racks for 12 to 24 hours to allow vacuum seal formation.
15. [SAFETY] Check lids after cooling to ensure vacuum seal by pressing center of lid; it should not flex up and down.

PRESSURE CANNING GREEN BEANS

1. Select young, tender beans free from mold and decay. Wash beans thoroughly and trim the ends.
2. Leave whole or cut beans into 1-inch pieces before packing into jars.
3. [SAFETY] For hot pack, cover beans with boiling water and boil for 5 minutes to blanch before packing.
4. [SAFETY] Pack hot beans loosely into hot jars, leaving 1 inch headspace.

5. Add salt if desired: 1/2 teaspoon per pint or 1 teaspoon per quart.
6. [SAFETY] Cover beans with boiling water, leaving 1 inch headspace.
7. [SAFETY] Remove air bubbles by running a plastic spatula or blunt knife around the inside of the jar.
8. [SAFETY] Wipe rims of jars with a clean, damp cloth to ensure a good seal.
9. [SAFETY] Adjust lids and screw on bands fingertip tight before processing.
10. [SAFETY] Follow manufacturer's directions for venting pressure canner; vent steam steadily for 10 minutes before pressurizing.
11. [SAFETY] Process in pressure canner at 240 deg F: 10 pounds pressure with weighted gauge or 11 pounds with dial gauge at sea level.
12. [SAFETY] Process pints for 20 minutes and quarts for 25 minutes at 240 deg F under proper pressure.
13. [SAFETY] After processing, remove canner from heat and wait until pressure returns to zero before opening the lid.
14. [SAFETY] Remove lid carefully and let jars stand for 5 minutes before removing. Then cool jars on towel away from drafts for 12-24 hours.

REFRIGERATOR PICKLES

1. [SAFETY] Wash cucumbers. Cut 1/16 inch off blossom end and discard.
2. Slice cucumbers into 1/4-inch slices.
3. [SAFETY] Pour boiling water over the cucumber slices and let stand 5 to 10 minutes.
4. Drain off the hot water and pour cold water over the cucumber slices. Let cold water run continuously or change water frequently until cooled.
5. [SAFETY] Mix vinegar, 1 cup water, Splenda®, and all spices in a 10-quart pot. Bring to a boil.
6. [SAFETY] Add drained cucumber slices carefully to boiling liquid. Return to a boil.
7. Place one cinnamon stick in each jar, if desired.
8. [SAFETY] With a slotted spoon, fill hot pickle slices into clean, hot pint jars, leaving 1/2-inch headspace.
9. [SAFETY] Cover with boiling hot pickling brine, leaving 1/2-inch headspace.
10. [SAFETY] Remove air bubbles and adjust headspace if needed.
11. [SAFETY] Wipe rims of jars with a dampened clean paper towel; apply two-piece metal canning lids.
12. [SAFETY] Process in a boiling water canner according to recommendations (e.g., 10 minutes at 0-1,000 ft elevation for pints).
13. [SAFETY] Let cool, undisturbed, 12 to 24 hours and check for seals.

FREEZING VEGETABLES

1. Select top-quality vegetables, harvest when cool if possible, and wash and sort them under cool running water to remove dirt and damaged pieces.
2. Peel, trim, and cut vegetables into pieces as directed for freezing; remove any damaged parts.
3. [SAFETY] Heat a large amount of water to a rolling boil or prepare steam with at least 1-2 inches of boiling water in a kettle with a tight-fitting lid.
4. [SAFETY] Put vegetables in a wire basket or steamer basket; for boiling water blanching, start timing when the water returns to boiling; for steam blanching, start timing when lid is on.
5. [SAFETY] Immediately cool blanched vegetables in ice water for the same amount of time as blanching to stop cooking.
6. Drain cooled vegetables thoroughly and pat dry to remove surface moisture before packaging.
7. [SAFETY] Pack blanched and dried vegetables into moisture- and vapor-resistant freezer bags or containers, leaving appropriate headspace according to the vegetable type (usually 1/2 inch or none).
8. [SAFETY] Remove excess air from packages/bags and seal tightly to prevent freezer burn and moisture loss.
9. [SAFETY] Freeze packaged vegetables promptly at 0 deg F (-18 deg C) or below for best quality and safety.
10. Mark packages with content and freezing date to ensure proper rotation and use within recommended storage times.
11. [SAFETY] To prepare, cook frozen vegetables by submerging in boiling water (~1/2 cup per pint), cover, simmer until tender; leafy greens and corn on the cob should be partially thawed before cooking.

MAKING FRUIT PRESERVES

1. Select firm, ripe fruit free of mold or damage, wash thoroughly, and remove stems, pits, or seeds as required by the recipe.
2. Mash or chop the fruit with a potato masher or knife as appropriate for the recipe, measuring accurately.
3. Combine fruit, sugar, and any added pectin or lemon juice according to recipe. Heat the mixture in a large saucepan over high heat, stirring constantly.
4. Bring the mixture to a full rolling boil over high heat, stirring frequently to prevent burning, until thickened to the desired consistency or to 220 deg F (8 deg F above boiling point of water).
5. Remove from heat and quickly skim off any foam from the surface to improve clarity and appearance.
6. [SAFETY] Ladle or pour the hot preserves into sterilized canning jars leaving 1/4 inch headspace; wipe jar rims to ensure a clean seal.
7. [SAFETY] Place sterilized flat lids on jars and secure with screw bands fingertip tight to allow air to escape during processing.
8. [SAFETY] Process the filled jars in a boiling water bath canner for 5 minutes for half-pints and pints (adjust for altitude as needed).
9. [SAFETY] After processing time is complete, turn off the heat, remove the canner lid carefully, and wait 5 minutes before removing jars to prevent siphoning.
10. [SAFETY] Cool jars undisturbed on a rack or towel at room temperature for 12-24 hours to allow proper sealing.
11. [SAFETY] Check lids for sealed concavity and resistance; remove screw bands and store jars in a cool, dark, dry place.
12. [SAFETY] If any jars do not seal properly, refrigerate and use within a few weeks to prevent spoilage and foodborne illness.